

From Kuka to Hawaii: What the Records Can Still Show

Sample report — fictional request, real sources

The request

My great-grandfather left for Hawaii in the 1890s. The family story and his papers say he came from Kuka village, Oshima District, Yamaguchi Prefecture (山口県大島郡久賀村). What was Kuka like when he left, why did so many people leave, which records could name him or his house, and what can I see there today?

Answer in brief

- Kuka was not an isolated hamlet: by 1897 it had its own police station and post-and-telegraph office, hosted Oshima District's own products fair, and its economy (like the rest of the district) ran on rice, cotton weaving, inshore fishing and silk alongside citrus and farming.
- Oshima District supplied about three in ten of the 944 people on Japan's first government-contract emigrant ship to Hawaii in 1885; by the time the contract scheme ended in 1894 the whole of what is now Suo-Oshima town had sent 3,913 of the nation's roughly 29,000 contract emigrants, and emigration continued after 1898 outside the contract system.
- No single record will name him and his house on its own. A koseki (family-register) request to Suo-Oshima Town Hall is the fastest, cheapest lead and is open to a great-grandchild without special justification; alongside it, Meiji passport-issuance registers, Foreign Ministry files on individual emigrants, Hawaii-published directories of Japanese residents and Hawaii's own passenger-manifest index can each independently confirm or extend the story.
- This session found and read a real 1889 account that names three Kuka villagers who died in Hawaii within a few years of arrival, and real, reference-coded Foreign Ministry files concerning Yamaguchi's Hawaii-resident nationals and a named case tied to Kuka's neighboring village — concrete proof that this kind of record survives and can be searched.
- Kuka itself can be walked today, and the Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum — itself a returned emigrant's 1928 house — is a short drive away with a database of about 130,000 Hawaii travel records to search by name.



This sample shows the format and the method of a Deep Research report. The client and the request are invented; every source, archive and record type described is real and was checked on 2026-09-28. Nothing in this report identifies a living person.

Kuka before the crossing

By the 1880s and 1890s, Kuka was one of about eleven villages into which the government had divided Oshima District (大島郡), the group of islands — chief among them Suo-Oshima itself — off the Yamaguchi coast in the Inland Sea. Far from a marginal hamlet, Kuka was administratively central to the district: when Oshima organized its second products fair in March 1897, the ten-day event was held in Kuka itself, in a large hall organizers borrowed for the purpose, at a site the organizers' own report locates in “Kuka village, the Ura section” (久賀村宇浦). The fair's opening and closing ceremonies were held at a shrine hall the report names 玉祖蛭子社 (the exact reading is not certain from the scanned text), and its prize-giving ceremony — attended by the prefectural governor in person — took place at Kuka's own Kakuhoji temple.²

That an entire district's fair, its organizing office and its printer's shop could all be based in Kuka points to a working village with real infrastructure, not a remote backwater. Among those who attended the fair's opening were the head of the Kuka police station and the head of the Kuka post-and-telegraph office, meaning that by 1897 Kuka's residents could already send mail and telegrams without leaving the village — a small but real detail for anyone imagining how a family later kept in touch with a member overseas. The trade associations whose leaders attended the award ceremony — a three-county cotton-weaving improvement union, an Oshima rice-improvement union, a fisheries union and a sericulture union — sketch an economy of small-scale weaving, rice farming on what lowland there was, inshore fishing and silk, alongside the citrus for which the island is known today.²

What this research could not establish remotely is a population or household count for Kuka itself in this period. The kind of source that would normally supply one — Yamaguchi Prefecture's annual statistical yearbooks, or a county-level administrative report of the 郡治一斑 type — exists but is catalogued at the National Diet Library as paper-only, outside the internet-accessible Digital Collections this session could search. What the sources agree on is the general shape of the island: mountainous, with limited farmland, wrapped around fishing coves, and reachable chiefly by boat until well into the twentieth century.

Why so many left: the government-contract years and after

Kuka's men and women who crossed to Hawaii left as part of one of the best-documented migrations in modern Japanese history. Under an 1885 agreement between the Kingdom of Hawaii and the Meiji government, Japan sent chartered ships of “government-contract emigrants” (官約移民) to work Hawaii's sugar plantations between 1885 and 1894. Suo-Oshima's own museum states that of the 944 men, women and children aboard the very first ship, which reached Honolulu on 10 February 1885, about three in ten came from Oshima District — a striking share for one rural district of one prefecture. A missionary priest who traveled to Hawaii himself only a few years later, in 1888–89, tallied the same first ship slightly differently: 677 men, 161 women and 111 children, “948 in all” (his own total; the three figures in fact add up to 949) — the kind of small discrepancy that is normal between a contemporaneous count and a later official one, and not worth over-reading.¹⁵

By the time the contract-emigration scheme ended in 1894, the museum's own figures put the total from the whole of what is now Suo-Oshima town (all of its old villages, Kuka among them) at 3,913 people — about 13.5% of the roughly 29,000 government-contract emigrants sent from all of Japan. An independent 2023 academic study built on the museum's own digitized records separately estimates that around 4,000 people from the wider Yashiro-jima area (Suo-Oshima) emigrated to Hawaii in the early Meiji period, a figure in the same range and a useful cross-check on the museum's own count. Oshima's outsized share had, on the evidence gathered here, at least three reinforcing causes: a mountainous island with little level farmland to support a growing population; an existing regional culture of 出稼ぎ — working away from home, whether on Inland Sea shipping or seasonal labor — that made a longer voyage a difference of degree rather than kind; and a real shortage of cash that the emigration companies' advanced fares and Hawaii's contract wages could answer. That the fare itself was a genuine barrier, one that local patrons sometimes bridged, shows in the case of a benefactor in Okiura village, Oshima District, who personally arranged financing so that 35 fellow villagers could afford to travel abroad — the same pattern, on a smaller scale, that a family story of borrowed passage money often reflects.^{4 816}

Those who went did not simply vanish from Kuka's account books. The museum describes remittances that supported families at home and funded donations to shrines and schools in the sending villages, and after Hawaii's 1898 annexation by the United States, emigration from the island continued outside the old contract system, with many Oshima natives becoming established figures in Hawaii's Japanese community. Some contract laborers, of course, never returned at all: the 1889 missionary account is explicit that his tally of 187 dead, recorded by personally visiting graves and reading Buddhist sutras over them, includes people identified as being from Oshima District, Kuka named among the villages, who died in the islands within a few years of arrival — a sobering context for any family story of a relative who “went to Hawaii” in this period and was, for a time, not heard from.¹⁸

The records trail: what could name him or his house

No single record is likely to answer the whole question by itself; family-history research into this period in Japan usually means combining several imperfect ones. The most direct is the koseki (戸籍), Japan's household-based family register, which — once the household is identified — can show a head of household, spouses, children, and the exact registered domicile (本籍) down to the house-lot, plus any move, marriage, birth or death later recorded in it. For a household in what is now Suo-Oshima town, requests go by mail to the town hall's Family Register Section: a printed request form, a photocopy of the requester's government ID, a fee paid by postal money order (450 yen for a current family-register transcript, 750 yen for a closed or reorganized one) and a stamped, self-addressed return envelope are all that is required. Crucially, the law allows the person themselves, a spouse, or any direct ancestor or descendant — a great-grandchild included — to request it without having to justify why; anyone else must state a specific legal reason.⁶⁷

The main practical risk is not eligibility but time. Closed family registers (除籍簿) must now be kept for 150 years from closure, but that rule only dates to a 2010 reform; before it the period was 80 years, so a register closed long ago may already have been legally destroyed. A related but separate record, the address-history attachment to the koseki (戸籍の附票), has had its own 150-year rule only since a 2019 reform, and a copy whose old five-year period had already lapsed by then — that is, closed on or before 19 June 2014 — can no longer be issued. Neither obstacle can be known in advance; only the request itself will show what still survives.⁹¹⁰

Behind the koseki sits a thinner layer of paperwork created because the family member left the country. Meiji Japan required a passport for overseas travel, and prefectures compiled 旅券下付表 (passport issuance registers) recording when and where each was issued; surviving volumes are now mostly held by the National Archives of Japan, and this research located one such register covering January 1888 to March 1891, with a gap from January to September 1889 — within the heart of the contract-emigration years — compiled by Kanagawa Prefecture and catalogued at both volume level (reference code A03032300700) and item level (A03032300800). A Yamaguchi-specific volume for the same years was not located in this session and would need a further, on-site search of the National Archives catalogue. A more promising vein is the Foreign Ministry's own case files on individual Japanese nationals abroad, digitized and freely viewable through JACAR, the Asia Historical Records Center: this research found a real, named 1894–95 file created jointly by Yamaguchi Prefecture and the mayor's office of Age-no-sho (安下庄村), Kuka's neighboring village in Oshima District, over one villager's military-conscription status while he was overseas (reference code B07090129800), and a 1922–24 exchange between the Yamaguchi governor and the Japanese consul-general in Honolulu over conscription travel costs for the prefecture's Hawaii residents (B07090141600). No equivalent Kuka file was found by keyword search, but the same series is organized by volume and rewards browsing directly rather than only searching by keyword.^{14 15}

On the Hawaii side, two further kinds of record are worth checking in parallel. Hawaii-published directories of notable or successful Japanese residents — a genre this research read directly, in a 1927 example — recorded a subject's exact birth date, registered domicile down to the village, Hawaii address, occupation and a short career narrative; being included required some local prominence, but even a family copy of such a directory, or a citation to one, is a lead worth following. More systematically, the Hawaii State Archives holds an index to all ship passenger manifests from 1843 to 1900, organized by nationality and then surname, recording name, age, occupation, co-traveling family members, the ship, and the exact arrival or departure date; part of this index is on the Archives' own Digital Archives site, though the Japanese-specific portion may still require a Research Room visit or a written request, and the Archives' own guide notes these passengers were usually tourists or residents rather than contract laborers, so it is a better lead for an independent traveler than for one of the 1885–94 contract group. The Emigration Museum in Suo-Oshima keeps a further, purpose-built resource of its own: a database room where visitors can search roughly 130,000 Hawaii travel records, official contract emigrants and independent travelers together — the single most efficient place to test whether a specific name and village turn up at all.^{38 1318}

What this session checked, and what it could not

This sample was researched entirely at a distance, in one working session, using only sources open to remote reading or query. We searched the National Diet Library's Digital Collections two ways: its cataloguing search, which found 1,399 distinct bibliographic records mentioning Suo-Oshima or Oshima District in some field, and its full-text search of digitized page images, which can find the exact scanned page ("frame") of a book where two phrases — say, 久賀村 and 布哇 (Hawaii) — appear together, even inside books the Library restricts to its own premises or to registered users. Of the internet-open books that search surfaced, we opened and read two in full through the Library's OCR text service: an 1889 missionary's travel account that turned out to record, by name, three Kuka residents who died in Hawaii in 1888–89, and an 1897 report of a district products fair that turned out to have been held in Kuka village itself. Both are cited above with their exact page numbers so the client, or anyone else, can open the same pages online.¹²

We separately queried the Asia Historical Records Center's (JACAR) own search system directly — it is not part of the Digital Collections — and found real, reference-coded Foreign Ministry files, described above, concerning Yamaguchi Prefecture's Hawaii-resident nationals and a named villager from Kuka's neighboring village. We also read the current, official web pages of Suo-Oshima Town (for the museum, and for the exact koseki mail-request procedure), the Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum's own site, the Yamaguchi Prefectural Archives, the Hawaii State Archives, and two Japanese municipalities' official explanations of the family-register retention rules, all checked on 28 September 2026.^{5 6 8 11 13 14 15}

Three things this session could not verify remotely, and a genuine Deep Research engagement would need to chase on-site. First, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs' own Diplomatic Archives website was unreachable from this session — a network restriction here, not a content problem — so its current reading-room procedures rely here on the National Diet Library's own guide to pre-war travel records rather than the Archives' page directly. Second, the Geospatial Information Authority's map- and aerial-photograph-ordering service was likewise unreachable; we confirmed programmatically, from the Authority's public photograph archive, that the oldest digitized, viewable aerial-photo mosaic covering Kuka in that archive dates to 1961–69, and that the Authority's own single-photograph index additionally lists an unstitched 1947 exposure of the same spot, by the U.S. military, that has not yet been scanned into a browsable layer; we could not identify which old paper topographic-map sheet, if any, shows Kuka from the Meiji or Taisho era. Third, and most important for a real client, no Kuka-specific population or household figure, and no Kuka-specific passport register or conscription file, turned up in this session; all three look likely to exist only on paper, in a local or prefectural archive, or in a JACAR series that needs volume-by-volume browsing rather than a keyword search — exactly the kind of gap an on-site visit, or a longer engagement, is for.^{12 17}

The on-site plan

A realistic next stage moves outward from the family record to the country: first the koseki, because it is cheap, fast and needs no travel; then Suo-Oshima itself, where the museum's own database and the physical village can be checked in the same trip; then the national archives, which between them hold the passport and consular paperwork; and only then, if a specific ship, year or name emerges, the Hawaii-side manifests and any temple or cemetery records on that end.

In practice we would request the koseki by mail before traveling at all, since the reply — or its absence — tells the researcher what to look for on the ground. We would visit the Emigration Museum and walk Kuka itself, including the harbor area (字浦) named in the 1897 fair report, asking locally after the shrine and temple it mentions, since well over a century of consolidation may have changed a building's name even where the site survives. Only if a name, date or reference code from the museum or the koseki points somewhere specific would we follow it into the Yamaguchi Prefectural Archives' catalogue, and from there into the National Archives and Diplomatic Archives material in Tokyo, most of which can be requested as copies without a researcher needing to be present for everything. The Hawaii-side check — the passenger-manifest index and, if a temple affiliation is known, that temple's own registers — can run in parallel by post or email throughout.^{6 8 11}

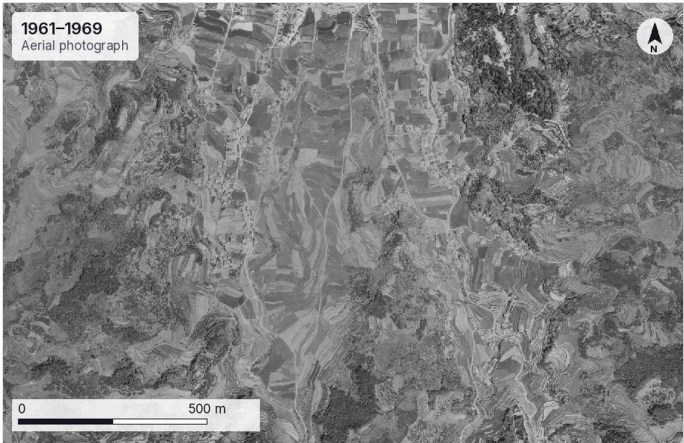
Kuka today

Kuka is a real, inhabited part of Suo-Oshima town today, on the island's north side around its own small harbor. Nothing this research reviewed suggests the kind of dramatic change that erases a place: no wartime destruction, and no large reclamation project, is recorded for this stretch of coast in the sources checked here. Comparing the earliest digitized aerial-photo mosaic of the hamlet held in the national online archive, from 1961–69, with the most recent orthophoto shows a settlement that has grown modestly rather than been rebuilt from nothing; the Authority's own photograph index lists a still-earlier, unstitched 1947 exposure of the area, worth requesting directly, alongside a walk on foot.¹⁷

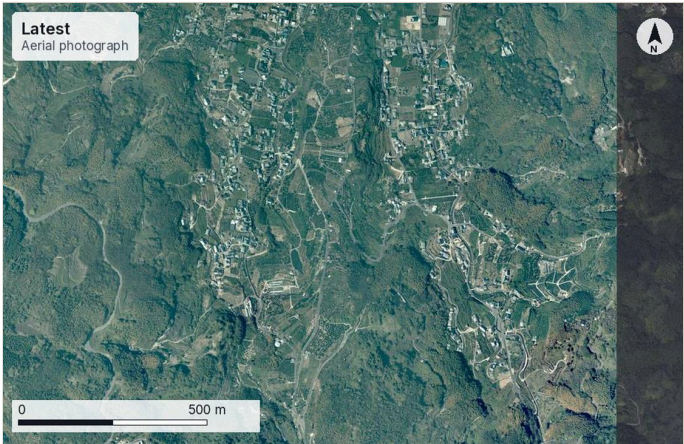
The single most tangible link between Kuka's story and the present is a short drive away, at the Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum on the island's western side. The museum is not a purpose-built structure but the actual house of Fukumoto Choemon, a Suo-Oshima man who returned from Hawaii in 1924 and built it in 1928 at a cost the museum itself puts at about 30,000 yen then — by its own estimate, upward of 300 million yen today. The house's blend of Japanese and Western styles is itself a physical record of what a successful return from Hawaii could look like, and it was formally recognized as a national Registered Tangible Cultural Property in February 2022. Inside, the museum's database room is where a family name first meets the record, and its displays of tools and photographs brought back by returnees are the closest most visitors will get to seeing what emigrant life actually involved.^{5 8}

None of this amounts to standing in front of a house we can say was his. What it does offer is a village that can be walked, a record system with a clear — if not guaranteed — path into it, and a museum built for exactly this kind of question. Whether his name surfaces in a koseki reply, a conscription file, a ship's manifest or a temple register is the work the next tier of this report, or a visit, is for.

Kuka then and now



Kuka, 1961-1969 (GSI *ort_old10*) — the oldest GSI aerial series that covers the hamlet.



The same frame, latest (GSI *seamlessphoto*). 1.8 × 1.2 km, north up.

Where the records are, and who can open them

Record and holder	What it can show	Access	Status
Koseki and closed-register (除籍/改製原戸籍) extracts for the household Suo-Oshima Town Hall, Family Register Section (戸籍住基班) — the present-day registry office for the former Kuka village	Head of household, family members, and births, marriages and deaths later recorded in it; the koseki-no-fuhyo variant shows the registered-domicile address history	By mail, from the person, a spouse, or a direct ancestor/descendant (a great-grandchild qualifies) with an ID copy and fee; anyone else must state a specific legal reason	client must request ^{6 7}
Meiji-era passport issuance registers (旅券下付表) Originally the issuing prefecture; surviving volumes mostly at the National Archives of Japan, some digitized via JACAR	Date and place of passport issue; where a full volume survives, the traveler's name and destination	Digitized volumes viewable free via JACAR; non-digitized volumes require an in-person or written National Archives request	checked remotely ¹⁴
Foreign Ministry files on individual emigrants abroad (e.g. 本邦人徴兵関係雑纂, conscription-abroad miscellany) Diplomatic Archives of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (外交史料館), digitized via JACAR	A named emigrant's home village and situation abroad, via correspondence between the prefecture, his village mayor's office and the consulate	Free to view online via JACAR for digitized items; the series can be browsed volume by volume as well as searched	checked remotely ¹⁵
Hawaii-published directories of Japanese residents (banzuke/meikan, e.g. 布哇日本人銘鑑) Published in Hawaii; copies at the National Diet Library (some open online) and at Hawaii/US libraries	Name, exact birth date, registered domicile down to the village, Hawaii address, occupation and a short career account, for those included	Several editions readable online at the National Diet Library now; others require in-person or registered-user access	checked remotely ³
Hawaii ship passenger manifests and their 1843–1900 index Hawaii State Archives	Name, age, occupation, co-traveling family, ship, and arrival or departure date and port — though the Archives' own guide says these passengers were usually tourists or residents, not contract laborers, so a government-contract-era emigrant may not appear in this index	Part of the 1843–1900 index is on the Archives' Digital Archives online; the Japanese-specific portion may need a Research Room visit or written request	needs on-site visit ¹³
The Emigration Museum's own travel-record database (about 130,000 entries) Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum, Suo-Oshima	Whether a name appears among the official and private emigrants indexed from the island, and what detail the entry carries	Search corner on site during opening hours (9:30–16:30, closed Mondays and 29 Dec–3 Jan); no evidence of remote/online public search was found	needs on-site visit ^{8 18}
Meiji/Taisho population, household and industry statistics for Kuka specifically Likely Yamaguchi Prefecture's annual statistical yearbooks, or district administrative reports; catalogued paper-only at the National Diet Library	Village-level population and household counts, and industry detail, for Kuka in specific years	Not available online; needs an on-site or by-request paper-catalogue search, e.g. at the Yamaguchi Prefectural Archives	needs on-site visit ¹¹

On-site plan

1	Request the household's koseki and koseki-no-fuhyo by mail, giving the great-grandfather's name, approximate birth year and “Oshima-gun, Kuka-mura” as the registered domicile	Suo-Oshima Town Hall, Family Register Section, 126-2 Oaza Komatsu, Suo-Oshima-cho	2–4 weeks by mail from outside Japan
2	Search the Emigration Museum's database room for the family name and Kuka, and view the exhibits on emigrant life and the government-contract years	Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum, 2144 Kamikatayama, Nishiyashiro, Suo-Oshima	Half a day
3	Walk Kuka itself, including the Ura harbor area, and ask locally after the shrine and temple named in the 1897 fair report	Kuka, Suo-Oshima	Half a day
4	Search the prefectural document catalogue for Oshima District/Kuka administrative and statistical papers	Yamaguchi Prefectural Archives, Yamaguchi City	1 day on site, or a written enquiry beforehand
5	Request or view the National Archives and Diplomatic Archives originals behind any promising JACAR reference codes	National Archives of Japan / Diplomatic Archives reading room, Tokyo	1–2 days, or by written request
6	Contact the Hawaii State Archives (and, for post-1900 arrivals, the US National Archives) to search passenger-manifest indexes and request copies	Hawaii State Archives, Honolulu, or by phone/email	Several weeks, by correspondence

What each price includes

US\$190	A report to this format for the client's own village or address: full remote search of the National Diet Library's Digital Collections (catalogue and full text), JACAR, and prefectural, municipal, museum and archive websites in Japan and Hawaii; the household's own koseki mail-request form filled in, translated and explained, ready to sign, copy an ID and post; a records trail and on-site plan tailored to the actual family name and village.
US\$390	Everything in the US\$190 tier, plus: submitting the koseki/joseki mail request on the client's behalf as an authorized proxy — with a signed authorization from an eligible relative, and through a licensed administrative scrivener (行政書士) partner where the relationship needs to be documented — and forwarding what comes back; a half-day search of the relevant museum's or archive's own on-site catalogue or database by a local researcher; and a two-page plain-English digest of anything found.

Limits

- This is a fictional client and request. No living person's name, address or contact details appear anywhere in this report. The historical individuals named in the 1889 and 1897 sources quoted here are long deceased, drawn from publicly available, out-of-copyright books, and are illustrations of what such records can show — not the fictional client's actual ancestors.
- No Meiji-era population or household count specific to Kuka itself (as opposed to Oshima District or Suo-Oshima as a whole) was found among the sources open to remote reading; the likeliest sources are paper-only at the National Diet Library and would need an on-site or by-request search.
- The Ministry of Foreign Affairs' Diplomatic Archives website and the GSI's old-map ordering service could not be reached from this research session (both blocked by network policy); the description of what they hold relies on the National Diet Library's own research guide and on JACAR's digitized holdings, and should be confirmed directly before any client visit.
- No historical page images, passenger-manifest scans or koseki forms were downloaded or reproduced in preparing this report; only bibliographic data, archive reference codes, page/frame numbers and our own notes are recorded here, as our sourcing policy requires.

Sources

1. 日曜點紅 (a Hongwanji-ha priest sent to Hawaii in 1888–89; the OCR reading of the name is uncertain), *布哇紀行* [A Journey to Hawaii], 1889; NDL frames 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 22, 24, 25, 26, 27, 29, 30. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/767401/1/26> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The priest's own passport process via the Foreign Ministry (frames 2–3); a Honolulu-area graveyard survey he conducted himself, recording 187 dead Japanese by name, home village and date, including entries explicitly “Yamaguchi Prefecture, Oshima District, Kuka village” (frames 26, 29); ship-by-ship arrival tallies for the first government-contract ships, 1885–89 (frame 24).
2. 山口県大島郡物産共進会事務所 (Oshima District Products Fair Office), *山口県大島郡第二回物産共進会報告書* [Report of the 2nd Oshima District Products Fair], 1897; NDL frames 1, 5, 8, 9, 12, 16, 26, 29, 41, 42. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/845597/1/5> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The fair's ten days (11–20 March 1897) and its venue built at “Kuka village, the Ura section” (frame 5); opening and closing ceremonies at a Kuka shrine and the award ceremony at Kuka's Kakuhoji temple, attended by the Kuka police chief and the Kuka post-and-telegraph office chief (frames 12, 16, 26); the district's cotton-weaving, rice, fisheries and sericulture trade associations (frame 16); the printer's colophon giving an address in Kuka village (frame 42); the roll of Oshima District village names, including Kuka, Yashiro and Age-no-sho (frames 8–9).
3. 曾川政男, *布哇日本人銘鑑* [Directory of Notable Japanese in Hawaii], 1927; NDL frames 87, 97, 130, 134, 151, 160. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1878964/1/87> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The format of this genre of Hawaii-published biographical directory: each entry gives a name, exact birth date, registered domicile (原籍地) down to the village, current Hawaii address, occupation and a career narrative — illustrating the kind of record that can independently confirm a named emigrant's home village (no Kuka entry fell within the pages read).
4. 選奨町村小学校各種団体及地方改良効労者事蹟 [Accounts of persons honored for local-improvement work in model towns, villages and schools], 1923; NDL frame 180. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/910985/1/180> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: An account of a benefactor in Okiura village, Oshima District, who personally arranged financing so that 35 villagers could afford the fare abroad — a concrete example of how the up-front cost of emigration was met.
5. 日本ハワイ移民資料館 [Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum (town page)], Suo-Oshima Town, Board of Education. <https://www.town.suo-oshima.lg.jp/soshiki/27/1740.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms Japan's first overseas emigration in 1885, 944 people in the first government-contract group of whom about 30% were from Oshima District, that about 1 million Japanese had emigrated overseas by the time emigration was banned in 1923, the museum's opening hours and admission, and the Fukumoto residence's recognition as a national Registered Tangible Cultural Property on 17 February 2022.
6. 郵送による戸籍謄本等の請求方法 [How to request a family-register transcript by mail], Suo-Oshima Town, General Affairs Division. <https://www.town.suo-oshima.lg.jp/soshiki/3/1144.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The exact mail-request procedure, fees (450 yen for a current transcript, 750 yen for a closed/reorganized one), required documents, and the town hall Family Register Section's address — the office that now holds the former Kuka village's registers.
7. 戸籍証明書の第三者請求について [Third-party requests for family-register certificates], Suo-Oshima Town. <https://www.town.suo-oshima.lg.jp/soshiki/3/9488.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms who may request a family-register certificate without special justification (the person, spouse, direct ascendants and descendants) and what a third party must show instead.
8. 日本ハワイ移民資料館 (*About / Exhibition information*) [Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum, official site], Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum (designated manager: Oshima International Exchange Association). <https://suooshima-hawaii-imin.com/about/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Opened 8 February 1999; the 1885–94 contract-emigration figure for the whole of Suo-Oshima (3,913 of Japan's roughly 29,000 contract emigrants, about 13.5%); remittances funding shrines and schools at home; the museum building as the reconstructed 1928 house of returned emigrant Fukumoto Choemon, built for about 30,000 yen then; the 1963 sister-island tie with Kauai.
9. 死者の戸籍 [Family registers of the deceased (FAQ)], Iga City, Resident Affairs Division. https://www.city.iga.lg.jp/faq/faq_detail.php?co=cat&frmid=338&frmCd=1-3-1-0-0, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: States the nationwide rule under the Family Register Act Enforcement Regulations: closed family registers (除籍簿) are now kept 150 years from closure, not from each person's death; before a 2010 reform the period was 80 years, so some older registers have already been legally destroyed.
10. 住民票の除票及び戸籍の附票の除票の保存期間が延長されました [Retention period extended for deleted resident-register and family-register-attachment copies], Oamishirasato City. <https://www.city.oamishirasato.lg.jp/0000011393.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The separate 2019 reform extending retention of address-history records (戸籍の附票の除票) from 5 to 150 years from 20 June 2019, with the caveat that copies already past the old 5-year period before that date (closed on or before 19 June 2014) can no longer be issued.
11. 利用案内 [User guide], Yamaguchi Prefectural Archives. <https://archives.pref.yamaguchi.lg.jp/guide/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Address and contact for the prefectural archives and its online holdings-search service, for locating Oshima District administrative and statistical papers.
12. 戦前の日本人の渡航記録について調べる [Researching pre-war Japanese travel records], National Diet Library. https://ndlsearch.ndl.go.jp/rnavi/business/travel_records, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Names the Diplomatic Archives' passport-issuance registers (旅券下付表) and traveler rosters as the key record types for pre-war emigrants, and notes that the National Diet Library itself holds almost none of the originals.
13. *Ships Passenger Manifests* [Ships Passenger Manifests], Hawaii State Archives, Dept. of Accounting and General Services. <https://ags.hawaii.gov/archives/about-us/genealogy-research-guide/ships-passenger-manifests/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms an index to all ship passenger manifests 1843–1900 by nationality then surname, the fields each manifest records, partial digital access, and that Japanese-specific indexing may still need an in-person Research Room visit.
14. 旅券下付表 (*search results*) [Passport issuance registers (JACAR search results)], Japan Center for Asian Historical Records (JACAR), National Archives of Japan. https://www.jacar.archives.go.jp/aj/search?kw=%E6%97%85%E5%88%B8%E4%B8%8B%E4%BB%98%E8%A1%A8&IS_KIND=summary&IS_STYLE=default&DB_ID=G0000101EXTERNAL&GRP_ID=G0000101&IS_START=1&DEF_XSL=default&IS_TF, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Locates one 1888–91 foreign-passport-issuance-register volume at the National Archives of Japan, compiled by Kanagawa Prefecture and catalogued at both volume level (A03032300700) and item level (A03032300800) — illustrating the record type and period, though not yet a Yamaguchi-specific volume — and a 1925 Foreign Ministry memo on the same annual return (B13080545300).
15. 山口県大島郡 旅券 (*search results*) [Records on conscription of Japanese nationals abroad, Yamaguchi/Oshima (JACAR search results)], Japan Center for Asian Historical Records (JACAR), Diplomatic Archives of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. https://www.jacar.archives.go.jp/aj/search?kw=%E5%B1%B1%E5%8F%A3%E7%9C%8C+%E5%A4%A7%E5%B3%B6%E9%83%A1+%E6%97%85%E5%88%B8&IS_KIND=summary&IS_STYLE=default&DB_ID=G0000101EXTERNAL&GRP_ID=G000, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Two named-individual case files tied to Yamaguchi Prefecture in the 本邦人徴兵関係雑纂 series, including one (reference code B07090129800) created jointly by the prefecture and the mayor of Age-no-sho, a neighboring Oshima District village, over a named man's military-conscription status while abroad, 1894–95; also a Yamaguchi governor's 1922–24 correspondence with the Honolulu consulate over conscription travel costs (B07090141600, found via a related search).
16. Sugii Manabu, Francisco Cruz Guerra Christian, Nagai Ryoko, Fujiwara Mami, *山口県の周防大島におけるハワイ移民のビッグデータ解析* [Big-data analysis of Japanese emigrants to Hawaii from Suo-oshima in Yamaguchi], Bulletin of Yamaguchi Science Research Center, vol. 3, pp. 8–14, 2023. <https://petit.lib.yamaguchi-u.ac.jp/29404>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: An academic GIS study built on the Emigration Museum's own database (about 29,730 digitized travel records), finding roughly 4,000 individuals from Yashiro-jima (Suo-Oshima) who emigrated to Hawaii in the early Meiji period and mapping their pre-departure addresses.
17. 空中写真 (地理院タイル) [Aerial photographs (GSI tile archive)], Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (国土地理院). <https://maps.gsi.go.jp/development/ichiran.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Photographic coverage was checked directly against Kuka's own coordinates (33.9377N, 132.2670E): the earliest digitized, viewable mosaic covering the hamlet in this archive is the 1961–69 series; the Authority's own single-photograph index additionally lists an unstitched 12 March 1947 U.S. military exposure of the same spot that has not been scanned into a browsable layer, while the 1928 series (limited to Osaka) and the 1936–42 series (limited to Tokyo and Osaka) do not reach it. 1974–83 imagery and the latest orthophotos also cover it.
18. 日本ハワイ移民資料館 (展示案内) [Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum (Exhibition information)], Japan-Hawaii Emigration Museum (designated manager: Oshima International Exchange Association). <https://suooshima-hawaii-imin.com/exhibition/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms the museum's Search Corner (検索コーナー) lets visitors search travel records for about 130,000 people (13万人分) who traveled from Japan to Hawaii, combining official contract emigrants and private travelers — the specific figure used in the report and in S8's own used-field, which this session had mistakenly sourced only to S8's About page.

Digitised books and archival records are cited, not reproduced. Aerial photographs: GSI, processed by Japan Time Atlas.